TFSA + RRSP + RESP + Margin Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right. Your TFSAs, RRSPs, your family's RESPs and your Margin and Cash accounts live side by side, at up to 8 brokerages. The tracker counts one TFSA room and one RRSP room for all your accounts, gives every child their own $50,000 lifetime limit and CESG count across every RESP, works out your margin loan from your cash flows, and keeps ONE pooled ACB for your taxable accounts, the way the CRA counts them.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue cell	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Child, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.
Navy / Green / Purple / Red / Teal / Slate	TFSA / RRSP / RESP / Margin & Cash / TFSA collateral / every account.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1IJutzj2uyInKuqaQpzN1BxUgNuRA6Lxsvta5SJexTa0/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds all 13 tabs. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Sort Transaction Log by Date	Puts every row in date order. Use it if you logged something late: the running ACB follows the row order.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample family: TFSAs at Wealthsimple and Questrade, RRSPs at RBC and TD, a family RESP for Emma (born 2015) and Liam (born 2019), a margin account at Wealthsimple with a loan, and a cash account at RBC with a sale. Prices come from today's market. Replaces anything in the log.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B5 to B8	Your name, province, Active Year and your birth year.	Change B7 every January. B9 shows your RRIF year.
B13 to B20	Up to 8 brokerages where you have any account.	Use exactly the same name every time.
C13 to C20	Each brokerage's yearly margin rate.	Blank if no margin account there.
D13 to D20	TFSA collateral rate, only if that brokerage lets you pledge your TFSA for your margin loan.	Ask your brokerage. Blank if not.
B23	The TFSA annual limit for the Active Year ($7,000 for 2026).	Update every January.
B24	Your TFSA room on January 1, from CRA My Account.	One number for ALL your TFSAs.
B31	Your RRSP deduction limit, from your Notice of Assessment.	It already includes unused room carried forward.
B32	Unused RRSP contributions, from the same notice (often $0).	B33 = B31 – B32, automatically.
B34	The $2,000 lifetime over-contribution buffer.	Rarely changes. B35 shows the deadline.
B43, B44	The year your oldest RESP was opened, and Family or Individual plan.	Sets the 31-year and 35-year dates.
B47 to E47	Each child's name (up to 4).	The names feed the Child dropdown.
B48 to E48	Each child's birth year.	Sets grant room and the last CESG year.
B49 to E49	RESP contributions for that child BEFORE the Active Year, by anyone, at any brokerage.	From your RESP statements.
B50 to E50	CESG received for that child before the Active Year.	From your RESP statements.
B72 to B78	Your family goals: TFSA, RRSP and RESP contributions, education savings, the year school starts, dividend income and family net worth.	Shown with progress bars on the Family Dashboard.
B81, B82	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B82 blank to use the live rate.
B86, B87	Your marginal tax rate, and the loan-to-value that should warn you (50% is cautious).	After-tax interest and the leverage warning.
B88 to B92	Capital gains inclusion, dividend gross-up and credit, US withholding, superficial loss window.	Grey: 2026 federal values.

The grey cells are a quick reference for each account (limits, deadlines, withholding, the CESG numbers). At the bottom are two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4, in date order. Never delete old rows: your room, your children's limits, your ACB and your holdings depend on the full history. **Already own investments?** Log each holding once as a Buy dated the day you start, with column M = what it cost you (in a Margin or Cash account, your ACB from your records). Log this year's contributions, withdrawals and grants with their real dates; earlier RESP contributions and CESG go in Settings rows 49 and 50.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The trade or contribution date (yyyy-mm-dd). For an RRSP contribution the date matters: January 1 to March 1 counts for LAST year's room.
B	Year	Automatic.

Col	Column	What to enter
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B13:B20.
D	Account	**TFSA, RRSP, RESP, Margin or Cash. Pick it on every row.** It decides which portfolio, which room and which cost pool the row counts in. Margin and Cash share one pool.
E	Child	**RESP rows only.** Pick the child on every Contribution, CESG, CLB, Provincial Grant and EAP. Buys, sells and dividends in a family plan can leave it blank.
F	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
G	Ticker	With the exchange prefix: TSE:XEQT, TSE:RY, NYSE:JNJ. Blank for contributions and grants.
H	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
I	Currency	CAD or USD.
J to L	Shares, Price, Commission	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
M	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency. Leave blank on a Buy or Sell and it is calculated.
N, O	FX Rate, Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up column O.
P	Realized Gain / Loss	Automatic on every Sell (and a Return of Capital above your ACB), using the running ACB of that pool. Only the Margin and Cash gains go on your return.
Q	Check	Automatic. Flags a missing institution, account, type, child, ticker, shares or amount, the wrong Contribution / Deposit type, an RESP-only type elsewhere, selling more than you hold, a possible superficial loss (including a buy-back in your TFSA or RRSP), and rows out of date order.
R to Y	Engine (hidden)	The running ACB, the cost pool and the cash effect of each row. Never type here.

Type	Use it for
Contribution	Money into a TFSA, RRSP or RESP. Uses TFSA room, RRSP room, or the child's $50,000 RESP limit.
Deposit	Money into a Margin or Cash account. Uses no room.
Withdrawal	Money out of a TFSA, RRSP, Margin or Cash account. A TFSA withdrawal comes back as room next January 1; an RRSP withdrawal is taxed and never comes back; a Margin withdrawal adds to your loan. RESPs use the types below.
Buy / Sell	Shares, price and commission.
Dividend / DRIP / Interest Income	Cash dividend, a dividend reinvested in new shares, or interest on cash. Log US dividends at the GROSS amount.
Margin Interest	The monthly interest your broker charges on your margin loan. Account = Margin. Line 22100.
Return of Capital / Reinvested Distribution	From an ETF's T3: return of capital lowers your ACB; a reinvested ("phantom") distribution raises it. Amount in column M.
Fee	Account or admin fees.
Transfer Out / Transfer In	A direct transfer between two of your accounts of the same kind at different brokerages. With a ticker and shares it moves shares; with no ticker it moves cash. Not a contribution.
CESG / CLB / Provincial Grant	RESP only. Grants paid into the RESP, with the child.
EAP	RESP only. Educational Assistance Payment (grants + growth) paid to a student, with the child.
PSE Withdrawal	RESP only. Your own contributions taken back while a child is in school (tax-free).
Non-Educational Withdrawal / AIP / Grant Repayment	RESP only. Contributions taken back when nobody goes to school, the Accumulated Income Payment, and grants repaid.

3. FAMILY DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
Big cards	Your TFSA, RRSP and RESP value (holdings at live prices + cash), your Margin & Cash equity (holdings + cash – loan) and the total, with your room left, the CESG this year, your loan and loan-to-value.
Brokerage cards	One column per brokerage plus All Brokerages: each account's value, the margin loan, total value, gain, this year's TFSA, RRSP and RESP contributions, RESP grants, dividends and margin interest.
Leverage block	Loan, margin holdings, loan-to-value against your warning level, extra borrowing power from your TFSA, interest paid, a full year of interest, break-even yield, income yield and after-tax cost.
TFSA room	Annual limit, room on January 1, contributions this year at every brokerage, room left, withdrawals and the room you get back next January 1.
RRSP room	Deduction limit, unused contributions, available room, contributions from March 2 to March 1 at every brokerage, room left and withdrawals. Warns you inside the $2,000 buffer and turns red beyond it.
Each child's RESP	One column per child: age, contributions this year and lifetime, room left of $50,000, the most CESG available this year, the CESG this year's contributions earn, how much more to contribute for the full grant, CESG lifetime and left of $7,200, other grants and a status. A message line tells you the most important thing to do.
Right column	Last 5 transactions, goals with progress bars, a tax snapshot (capital gains, eligible dividends, Lines 22100, 20800 and 12900, RESP grants, EAPs, AIP) and the RESP timeline with your education goal.
Charts	Value by brokerage per account, dividends by month per account, and CESG per child.

4. TFSA, RRSP AND RESP PORTFOLIOS

All three tabs are automatic. Each ticker appears once per tab, with the shares held at every brokerage combined, the average cost, live price in CAD, market value, gain or loss, return and dividends. Below the totals: cash not invested and the total value of that account. **The accounts never mix:** if you own ENB in your RRSP and your margin account, each tab has its own ENB line with its own cost. None of these numbers goes on this year's tax return.

5. MARGIN & CASH PORTFOLIO

Every Margin and Cash account at every brokerage, combined, with ONE pooled ACB per stock: the CRA method. The shares and ACB come from the running engine in the Transaction Log, so each sale uses the right average cost. Columns J and K show this year's realized gain and income per stock. Below the totals: your cash balance (negative = margin loan) and your equity.

6. MARGIN & COLLATERAL

Cards for interest paid, your loan, the average rate, a full year of interest, your margin holdings, the break-even yield, your income yield and the extra borrowing power from your TFSA. Section A shows each brokerage: rate, loan, monthly interest, loan-to-value, TFSA value, collateral rate and a status. Section B compares interest and income month by month, with a chart.

7. TAX SUMMARY

For your Margin and Cash accounts only, at every brokerage: sell proceeds, ACB sold, net and taxable capital gain, eligible dividends (grossed up), foreign income and margin interest. Section A maps each amount to its T1 line (12000, 40425, 12100, 40500, 12700, 22100), plus your RRSP deduction (20800), RRSP withdrawals (12900) and EAPs (taxed to the student). Section B checks each brokerage against its T5008 slip. Section C lists every sale for Schedule 3.

8. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

Every brokerage side by side: TFSA, RRSP, RESP and Margin & Cash market value and cost, unrealized gain, cash, the margin cash balance, total value, margin rate, TFSA borrowing power, margin interest, this year's contributions and grants, dividends and realized gains (to compare with that broker's T5008). Your TFSA and RRSP room blocks sit underneath. On the right, a donut chart shows the share of your money at each brokerage.

9. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Cards for TFSA (tax-free), RRSP (tax-deferred), RESP (sheltered) and Margin & Cash (taxable) dividends this year, the total, a full-year estimate and your goal. A note shows the US withholding lost in your TFSA and RESP, saved in your RRSP and claimable in your taxable accounts. Section A splits each month by account; Section B lists every dividend; Section C totals each ticker by account.

10. TFSA, RRSP, RESP & MARGIN RULES

Colour-coded cards: red = costly mistake, amber = limit or deadline, green = benefit. Sections: the registered accounts, your TFSA, your RRSP, RESP contributions, RESP grants, paying for school, the TFSA + margin link, capital gains and ACB, margin interest and risk, dividends and slips, and which account to fill first. The Government Rules PDF explains each one with examples.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Question	Answer
My child's RESPs are at two brokerages. Is that a problem?	No, as long as you pick the child on each contribution. The tracker adds both towards ONE $50,000 limit and ONE $7,200 CESG maximum for that child.
Grandparents have an RESP for my child too.	Add their past contributions to Settings row 49, and log new ones as Contributions for that child. Every RESP counts towards the same limit.
My RRSP contribution in February does not show in my RRSP room.	Correct: a contribution from January 1 to March 1 counts for last year. The room block counts March 2 to March 1.
Why does "Max CESG this year" show $1,000?	The child has unused grant room from earlier years. Contributing $5,000 for that child this year collects the full $1,000.
Where do I type my margin loan?	Nowhere. It is the negative cash balance of your Margin account, worked out from deposits, withdrawals, buys, sells, dividends, interest and fees.
My broker's book value is different from the ACB here.	Normal: each broker only sees its own shares. For taxes, use the pooled ACB in this tracker.
A chart is blank.	Menu: Rebuild Dashboard Charts.

Question	Answer
New year?	Make a copy, change B7, update B23 and B24 (CRA My Account), B31 and B32 (Notice of Assessment), each child's rows 49 and 50 and your margin rates, and keep logging below your old rows.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca. Always confirm your own TFSA room in CRA My Account, your RRSP limit on your Notice of Assessment and your children's grants with your RESP provider. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca